

Free Lighting

Kapurchand was a **miser**. He was the owner of a restaurant. But **in spite of** its **elegant décor**, business was **slack**, especially in the evenings. This was because the other restaurants in the neighbourhood had attractive **neon name-boards** which **drew** all the customers away from Kapurchand's restaurant.

"I could **put up** a neon sign on my restaurant too," **muttered** Kapurchand, "but electricity costs so much these days. I wish I could get it for free."

The area **abounded** with fireflies. One day, an idea **flashed into** Kapurchand's **mind**. He immediately had the name of his restaurant painted with sugar syrup. At night, millions of fireflies **settled** on the syrup and Kapurchand got his free lighting.



The Weaver and the Spirit

Once a **weaver** was at work when his loom broke. So he took his axe and went to the jungle to get wood.

He spotted a huge tree. He thought if he **axed** it, he would get enough wood to make many looms. As he **approached** the tree, a voice stopped him. A spirit which lived on the tree asked the weaver not to cut down the tree that had been his home for many years.



The weaver said he had no choice as he needed wood for his loom and his family would die of **starvation** if he couldn't continue with his work.

The spirit then said, "I can grant you any wish if you **spare** the tree."

The weaver said he would consult his wife. He came home and **sought** her advice. She said he should not ask for riches and kingdoms as they brought with them **misery** and **sorrow**. Instead, she advised him to ask for one more head and two more hands so that he could weave two pieces of cloth a day.

The weaver returned to the jungle and expressed his wish to the spirit. His boon was granted immediately.

When the weaver was spotted with two heads and four arms, the villagers thought he was a monster and they **pelted** him with stones.

Moral: Never act blindly upon others' advice. Use your **discretion**.

Story - 01

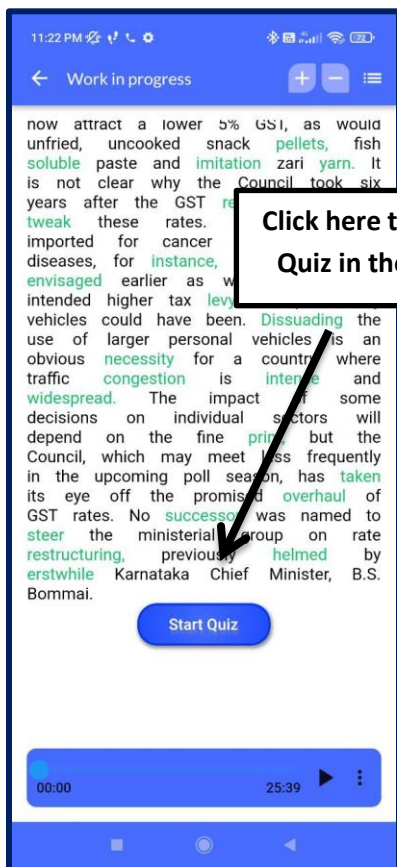
1. **Miser** (noun) – penny-pincher, tightwad, skinflint, hoarder, cheapskate कंजूस
2. **In spite of** (phrase) – despite, although, even though, regardless of, albeit के बावजूद
3. **Elegant** (adjective) – graceful, stylish, sophisticated, refined, tasteful सुंदर और आकर्षक
4. **Décor** (noun) – furnishing, interior design, arrangement, setting, ornamentation सजावट
5. **Slack** (adjective) – slow, inactive, dull, weak, sluggish मंद
6. **Neon name-board** (noun) – a sign that uses neon lighting to display a name or other text.
7. **Draw** (verb) – attract, pull, lure, entice, bring आकर्षित करना
8. **Put up** (phrasal verb) – install, erect, display, mount, set up लगाना
9. **Mutter** (verb) – murmur, whisper, grumble, mumble, complain बड़बड़ाना
10. **Abound** (with) (verb) – overflow, teem, be filled, be plentiful, be rich प्रचुर मात्रा में होना
11. **Flash (into) one's mind** (phrase) – occur suddenly, strike, pop up, spring to mind, come to mind अचानक ध्यान में आना
12. **Settle** (verb) – rest, perch, land, take position, stay बैठना

Story - 02

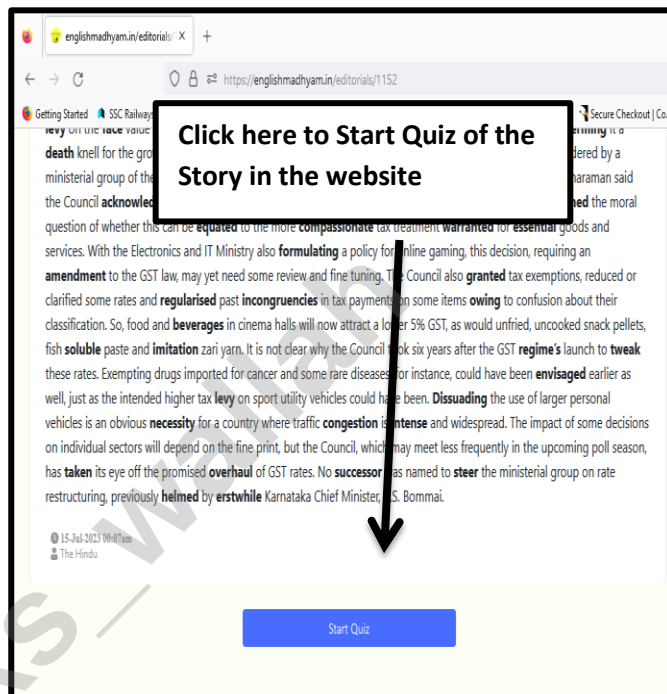
1. **Weaver** (noun) – textile worker, loom operator, fabric maker, craftsman, artisan बुनकर
2. **Axe** (verb) – chop, cut, hack, hew, fell कुल्हाड़ी से काटना
3. **Approach** (verb) – come near, move toward, reach, advance, go closer पास जाना
4. **Starvation** (noun) – hunger, famine, malnutrition, undernourishment, deprivation भूखमरी
5. **Spare** (verb) – save, protect, avoid, refrain from, withhold छोड़ देना
6. **Seek** (verb) – ask, request, pursue, inquire, look for माँग करना
7. **Misery** (noun) – suffering, anguish, hardship, distress, torment दुःख
8. **Sorrow** (noun) – grief, sadness, regret, heartbreak, woe शोक
9. **Pelt** (verb) – throw, hurl, bombard, strike, lob पत्थर मारना
10. **Discretion** (noun) – judgment, prudence, wisdom, sense, caution विवेक

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Practice Exercise



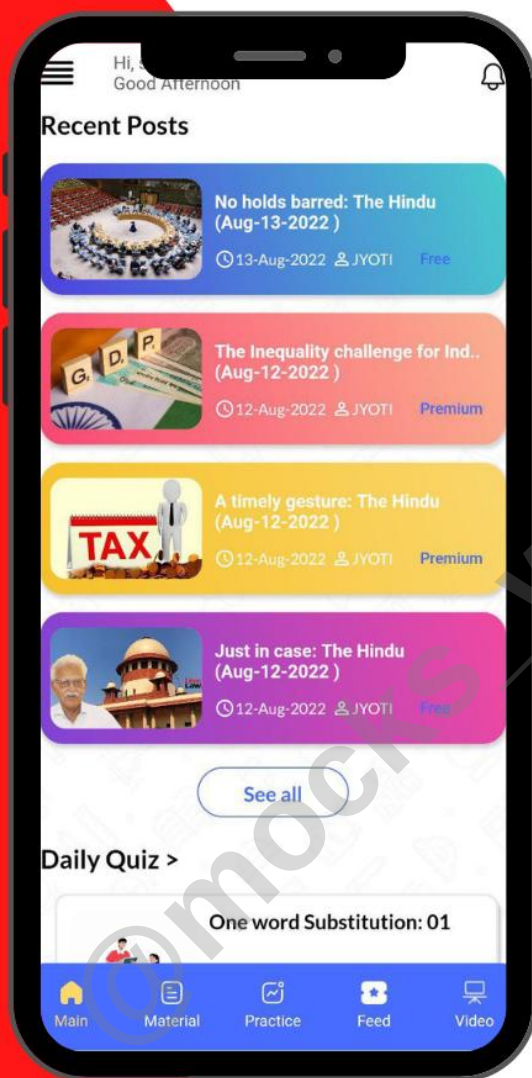
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